

How do DoView strategy/outcomes diagrams differ in terms of their evidential status?

Some confusion can arise from the evidential status of different DoView strategy/outcomes diagrams and what they can, therefore, tell us about an agency, provider, policy or initiative's proven effectiveness. The Four Types of DoView Strategy Diagrams With Differing Evidential Status Tool (B12) shows the four different types of DoView diagrams based on their evidential status.

From an evidential point of view, the first type of DoView strategy/outcomes diagram that can be drawn is a 'Planning DoView Diagram' showing the logic of how it is 'believed' an intervention will work. The hope is that the 'This-Then' logic in the DoView will play out because the steps being taken will result in high-level outcomes being achieved. However, such a planning DoView diagram does not say anything about whether the DoView's 'This-Then' links are evidentially defensible based on previous research and evaluation on other initiatives. It also does not say anything about what can be proved is happening in the case of the current implementation of the initiative.

The second type of DoView diagram is an 'Evidence-Based DoView diagram' that has been validated against previous research and evaluation of initiatives similar to the one that is now being implemented. It shows the existing evidence supporting the links between the boxes in the DoView based on reviewing the previous research and evaluation literature. Alternatively it can be based on asking experts in the relevant field to peer-review the proposed DoView diagram. Their views about whether the 'This-Then' flow in the diagram is credible are then incorporated into the Evidence-Based DoView.

The third type of DoView diagram is an 'Implementation DoView Diagram'. This shows what it is believed is being implemented on the ground in the case of the particular implementation of the intervention.

The fourth type of diagram is an 'Evaluated DoView Diagram'. It is informed by impact and other evaluation of the current implementation of the initiative being run.